THE 17 – 21 ENGLISH COUNTY CHALLENGE

SATURDAY/SUNDAY 11th/12th APRIL 2026

REGULATIONS

Updated July 2025

NAME

1. The competition shall be called '**The 17-21 English County Challenge.**'

MANAGEMENT

2. The **17-21 English County Challenge** will be managed by Yorkshire Badminton Association (YBA). Subject thereto each competing county shall be responsible for all matters affecting its county teams.

PROGRAMME OF COMPETITION

3. The participating teams will compete in a **Challenge** weekend to be played at **York RI. (**There will be no regional competition prior to the Challenge weekend.)

4. Round 1 will be played on the Saturday and Round 2 will be played on the Sunday.

TEAMS

5. A maximum of 16 Teams will be accepted to play in the Challenge weekend. Each County may enter 1 team. Counties who played the 2025 Challenge will receive priority. However, if there are less than 16 Teams, then Counties will be asked if they wish to enter a second team.

6. The teams will be seeded, using the latest individual player gradings/rankings as published by Badminton England on Tournament Software.

ENTRY FORMS

7. County associations shall submit an entry form to YBA by the 30th September. Entries accepted after this date will be at the discretion of YBA.
   The entry fee of **£175.00** will be paid to YBA by each of the counties entered.

ELIGIBILITY OF PLAYERS

8. **All players must be born in the years 2004, 2005, 2006, 2007 & 2008.**

9. **Players must have current Active Membership of Badminton England.**
   Players do not need to be a Compete Member.
   Players must be eligible to play for their county, as stated in the current Badminton England County Championship Regulations.
   However, due to some counties having difficulty in recruiting players, the following exception can apply.
   One player from a neighbouring County may be selected providing: -
   a) The neighbouring County are not entering the tournament

b) The player has not played in any team competition for that County in the current season
c) The neighbouring County give their permission

(It should be noted that whilst Badminton England are aware of the above eligibility provision, it only applies to this competition by decision of the 17-21 ECC Management Committee)

10. Appeals can be made to YBA for exceptional circumstances.

FORMAT OF COMPETITION (Based on 16 Teams)

11. All matches will be the Best of Three Games to 21, with Extended Scoring to 30.

12. Round 1

a) Based on the seedings, teams shall be divided into four groups of four. Groups A, B, C, & D. No1 seeds will play in Grp A, No2 in Grp B, No3 in Grp C, No4 in Grp D. Within each group all teams play each other.

b) Each tie shall consist of six events:
I Men's Singles II Women's Singles III Men's Doubles
IV Women's Doubles V 1st Mixed Doubles VI 2nd Mixed Doubles

c) The singles players cannot play in the men's and women's doubles matches.

d) The mixed doubles pairs must be ranked in order of strength. The higher ranked pair will play the 1st mixed doubles match.

e) Unless otherwise determined by the Referee, the order of play in each tie shall be firstly both singles matches, immediately followed by the men's and women's doubles matches, with the mixed doubles last.

f) Players will be entitled to at least 10 minutes break after any best of three level doubles match, if they are playing in the mixed doubles matches. These periods are inclusive of the notice period.

g) Any player or pair absent or unwilling to play when required to do so shall forfeit the match concerned, which shall be scored as a win for the opponents by two games to love.

13. Round 2

a) Following the first round, teams will be divided into four new groups to decide on final league placings. Groups E, F, G & H.
Group E will consist of the winners from Groups A, B, C & D and will play for 1st to 4th places.
Group F will consist of the second placed teams & play for 5th to 8th places.
Group G will consist of the third placed teams & play for 9th to 12th places.
Group H will consist of the fourth placed teams & play for 13th to 16th places.

b) In each group the Team from Group A will play the Team from Group D & the Team from Group B will play the Team from Group C.

c) In Group E the winners will then play for first/second places and the losers will play for 3rd/4th places.

d) The same format will apply for the other three groups.

(Note - Paragraphs 12 & 13 will be changed if less than 16 teams entered)

DECISIONS OF TIES

14. Group Matches

a) The winner of a tie shall be decided by the number of matches won.

b) 3 points for a tie won
2 points each for a tie drawn – 3 matches each.
1 point for a 2 matches to 4 loss

c) The winner of a group shall be the team that wins the most number of points.

d) Should two or more teams be equal on points, the total number of ties won shall decide. If two of more teams are still equal the total number of matches won shall decide. If teams are still equal then the greatest difference between games won and games lost shall decide. If two teams are still equal then the number of section points won in the ties between them shall decide. If there is still no decision or if three or more teams are equal the total number of games won shall decide.

15. Knock Out Matches

a) The winner of a tie shall be decided by the number of matches won.

b) Where the result is a draw (both teams have 3 matches each), then the greatest difference between games won and games lost shall decide. If both teams are still equal then the number of section points won shall decide. If both teams are still equal, then the result of the first mixed doubles match shall decide.

TEAM LISTS

16. Each county, shall at least 20 minutes before commencement of each tie, hand to the Referee a team list giving the names of the players and their pairings to play that tie.

CONSTITUTION OF TEAMS

17. (a) Different players and pairs may be selected for different ties subject to a minimum of three men and three women being played in any one tie.

(b) No player may play in more than two events in any one tie.

18. General

(a) A county shall appoint a captain or team manager of its team for each tie and in default a team shall appoint its own captain/manager.

(b) In the event of any player being incapacitated after play in a tie has begun, so that they cannot continue playing, a captain shall be entitled to include a substitute in any subsequent matches in which such incapacitated player should have taken part, provided that:
(i) the referee AND the opposing team captain/manager have been notified of the intention to substitute the incapacitated player;
(ii) the injury or other incapacity was caused entirely after play in the tie had begun and was not due solely to tiredness or the worsening of an existing ailment.

(iii) the substitute shall be available to play when required:
Subject to the foregoing, if a substitute is required for a player selected for two events, a different substitute may be included for each such event, but no substitute shall be a player who has already been selected to play in that particular event. Any dispute should be referred to the Referee whose decision shall be final.

c) A squad list from which your team will be selected should be submitted to YBA by 09/03/26, with the players correct affiliation numbers. In addition you will be asked to provide a list of 4 possible Mixed Pairs in rank order.

d) The Draw for Round 1, with start times, will be published by 23/03/26.

RESULTS

19. The results of every match together with the full scores and the names of players, signed by the captain or team manager of both teams, shall be given to the Referee by the winning team.
Results will be made available at the Tournament and on Tournament Software.

PRIZES

20 The winning team will receive the YORKSHIRE COOK-MILNE TROPHY.
Medals will be awarded to the players of the winning, second & third placed teams.

REFEREE AND DUTIES

21. YBA have appointed a Referee for the Challenge weekend.

22. It shall be the duty of the Referee:
(a) to be in overall charge of the ties;
(b) to settle any matters of dispute, including, but not restricted to, the speed of shuttles, ranking of players, substitutions, and clothing;
(c) to fulfil the duties concerning misconduct, disqualification of players, and appeals on questions on the Laws of badminton;
(d) to fulfil the duties regarding notification of results;

CLOTHING

23. The Badminton England Clothing Regulations shall apply. All clothing should be acceptable badminton sports clothing and wherever possible, doubles partners should wear the same colours.

COMPLAINTS

24. Any complaints should be submitted to YBA/BADMINTON England.

PENALTIES

25. Penalties for the Challenge weekend shall be enforced in accordance (were appropriate) with the Senior County Championships Regulations on Penalties.
In addition, the Penalty System as detailed in the BADMINTON England Regulations for Tournaments shall apply, with specific reference to (although not exclusive to) Cards for Misconduct.

26. **The last date which a team may withdraw without penalty is: -**
SATURDAY 31st JANUARY 2026.

SCHEDULE

27. There are 9 courts at York RI. For each tie two courts will be allocated. Court No.1 will be used for warm-up. If a tie is well behind schedule then Court 1 may be used at the discretion of the Referee.
(Where possible teams with furthest to travel on the Saturday, will be given the 11.15hrs start time)

The schedule for the weekend, with 16 teams playing, is as follows: -

SATURDAY

09.30hrs	Group A & Group B – First Leg of matches
11.15hrs	Group C & Group D – First Leg of matches
13.00hrs	Group A & Group B – Second Leg of matches
14.45hrs	Group C & Group D – Second Leg of matches
16.30hrs	Group A & Group B – Third Leg of matches
18.15hrs	Group C & Group D – Third Leg of matches
20.00hrs	Finish

SUNDAY

09.30hrs	Group G & Group H – First leg of matches
11.30hrs	Group E & Group F – First leg of matches
13.30hrs	Group G & Group H – Last matches to decide league placings
15.30hrs	Group E & Group F – Last matches to decide league placings
17.30hrs	Finish